

Apple and Samsung. Many brands have tried to enter this space but not with any great success,” says IDC’s Singh. The opportunity for Pixel will be in looking at parts of the overall mix. Adds Pathak: “Pixel phones have pure Android, providing a smooth UI experience with a camera performance that is among the best.”

Google’s approach has been to push its capabilities. In fact, so dominant has Android been that it has been pulled up for being, well, too dominant. Last October, the CCI levied a fine of ₹1,337.76 crore on Google for taking advantage of Android’s

has over 90 per cent market share across most of its products in multiple countries,” says Whisperer’s Bindra. Adds Arush Khanna, Partner at Numen Law Offices: “This [the SC judgement] was the third hit faced by Google after losing the appeal over the EU’s anti-trust ruling for placing unlawful restrictions on the manufacturers of Android mobile devices and mobile network operators to consolidate the dominant position of its search engine.” On his part, Gupta emphasises that Google has added more granular controls for Android phone users. “They can

years that Google Search would do. Hence, it presents a real threat to the company, even though ChatGPT is still in testing phase. Google is taking it very seriously, so seriously that the company’s hands-off Founders Sergey Brin and Larry Page have reportedly turned up in office to strategise with executives and developers. And the result is expected to be a phalanx of more than 20 AI-based innovations this year that will seek to crush this rebel.

Clearly, the next phase of Google’s evolution has begun, 25 years after it was founded by Brin and Page. Bindra



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MOHIT KAPOOR
EXECUTIVE VP & GROUP CTO,
MAHINDRA GROUP



“IT [GOOGLE] DOMINATES SEARCH, VIDEO, PAYMENTS AND MAPS; IT IS WELL-POSITIONED HERE... LOW PENETRATION, GROWTH IN AD WORK IN ITS FAVOUR”

JASPREET BINDRA
FOUNDER,
TECH WHISPERER UK

massive market share, and not allowing fair access to competing apps in Android-powered smartphones. It also prescribed several actions that the company needs to take. The National Company Law Appellate Tribunal declined Google’s request for a stay and the issue moved to the SC. In January, the apex court, too, upheld the orders of the CCI and NCLAT. In line with this, Google has implemented some changes, including allowing users to select a default browser, and allowing handset manufacturers to license individual Google apps for pre-installation on their devices.

Globally, too, regulators have started clamping down on the company’s dominant activities. “Google is squarely in the crosshairs since it

control which apps have access to which data. The apps only get access to the extent where it is required to implement the core functionality.”

Apart from regulation, there is the not-so-small matter of a serious challenge to its search dominance from ChatGPT, a chatbot launched by AI research firm OpenAI last November, where Microsoft is reportedly looking to invest \$10 billion. ChatGPT produces search results that appear like human answers. It can converse freely with a human on multiple subjects, compose poetry, write code (and detect bugs, too), even produce philosophical musings. It comes as close to generating human insights as any chatbot ever has. Bottom line: it does what humans have wished for

says Google did not discover search but did three things very well. “They put together a better algorithm to make it more effective. They also built a tech architecture and algorithm that could scale to global levels rapidly,” he points out. Most importantly, Google built a business model around it, “which has emerged as perhaps the best for any product in any industry across time”.

That business acumen, and tech wizardry, will be severely tested as Google moves into its next phase. And India, with its tech talent and rapidly digitising market, might just play an important role in that journey. **BT**

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